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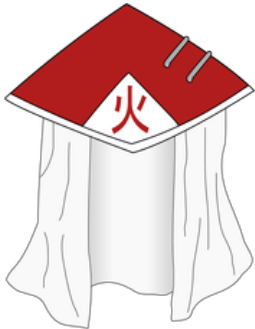
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Hokage

15+ EDIT

The **Hokage** (火影, *literally meaning: Fire Shadow*) is the [Kage](#) of [Konohagakure](#), a title bestowed on the village's most respected and outstanding shinobi^[1] as their leader. The Hokage is generally regarded as the strongest [shinobi](#) in the village. There have officially been seven Hokage in the village's history.



The Hokage's hat.

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Overview



The Hokage Rock.

The Hokage position was created shortly after the creation of Konoha by [Hashirama Senju](#), one of the village's founders. The Hokage typically selects their successor. If they die or are otherwise incapacitated, the next Hokage is instead chosen by the [daimyō](#) of the [Land of Fire](#) with the advice of his committee, the [Konoha Council](#), the [Jōnin Commander](#) and a representative of the [Anbu](#). This choice must then be approved by Konoha's [jōnin](#).^[2] If one of the Hokage's predecessors is still alive, they may return to office rather than select a new Hokage, as when the Third came out of retirement following the Fourth's death. The choice appears to be difficult to decline, if not impossible - [Jiraiya](#) was forced to find [Tsunade](#), a suitable substitute, to escape the pre-arranged promotion that would have made him Fifth Hokage.^[3] The Hokage's inauguration is a major event in Konoha, with most of the village attending. The new Hokage is granted a ceremonial [haori](#) on the occasion; the same woman has embroidered the haori for all seven Hokage.^[4] Once they assume the duties of Hokage, their face is carved into the [Hokage Rock](#) and they usually move in to the [Hokage Residence](#). The Hokage's office is located in the administrative section of the [Academy](#).

Hokage are responsible for most of the village's day-to-day affairs, such as assigning the village's ninja to [missions](#) or securing funding for the village's projects and personnel. The Hokage spends most of their time in the village, only travelling abroad for events of vital importance to Konoha. Each Hokage typically lives according to the [Will of Fire](#), a philosophy that holds that Konoha is a family and that the Hokage is chiefly responsible for protecting that family. The workload of Hokage can be quite formidable, and as such retired Hokage may continue to oversee certain sections of the village or, if not that, will advise the current Hokage on request. Over a decade after the [Fourth Shinobi World War](#), the workload of the Hokage had expanded tremendously due to the expansive growth that Konohagakure enjoyed after the War, as well as the Hokage's duties becoming nearly that of a pseudo-head of state in the [Land of Fire](#). As such, until his schedule lessened, the [Seventh Hokage](#) would be swamped with paperwork and other appearances all over the village turned city to the point where even his massive [chakra](#) reserves would be depleted. And he would be unable to spend time with his family, temporarily forming a rift between himself and his [eldest son](#).

List of Hokage



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First Hokage

Main article: [Hashirama Senju](#)



Hashirama Senju, the First Hokage.

[reincarnation](#) and descendant of [Asura Ōtsutsuki](#). He himself was hailed as the "God of Shinobi" for his unmatched ninja prowess. Hashirama sought peace for the shinobi world, and to that end founded [Konohagakure](#) with his clan, his childhood friend and rival: [Madara Uchiha](#), and the [Uchiha clan](#). He later became the **First Hokage** (初代火影, *Shodai Hokage*, *literally meaning*: First or Founding Fire Shadow) of Konohagakure. Although he was not able to achieve peace during his lifetime, his legacy and vision for the world continued to shape the village and the entire shinobi world even after his death.

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Second Hokage

Main article: [Tobirama Senju](#)



Tobirama Senju, the Second Hokage.

Tobirama Senju (千手扉間, *Senju Tobirama*) was a member of the renowned [Senju clan](#), who, together with his elder [brother](#) and the [Uchiha clan](#), founded the first shinobi village: [Konohagakure](#). Throughout his lifetime, Tobirama would work tirelessly to achieve political stability and implement the institutions that made the village system work, thus ensuring Konoha's continuity and prosperity. After his brother's death, he would earn the title of **Second Hokage** (二代目火影, *Nidaime Hokage*, *literally meaning*: Second Fire Shadow).

Third Hokage

Main article: [Hiruzen Sarutobi](#)



Hiruzen Sarutobi, the Third Hokage.

Hiruzen Sarutobi (猿飛ヒルゼン, *Sarutobi Hiruzen*) was the **Third Hokage** (三代目火影, *Sandaime Hokage*, *literally meaning*: Third Fire Shadow) of [Konohagakure](#). A disciple of the village's two previous Hokage, Hiruzen was a powerful ninja, hailed as a "[God of Shinobi](#)" and also renowned as **The Professor** (プロフェッサー, *Purofessā*) for extensive and immense mastery of various ninjutsu. Though he was only ever directly the teacher of the [Sannin](#), generations of Konoha



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shinobi benefited from his wisdom during his lifetime.

Fourth Hokage

Main article: [Minato Namikaze](#)

Minato Namikaze (波風ミナト, *Namikaze Minato*) was the **Fourth Hokage** (四代目火影, *Yondaime Hokage*, literally meaning: Fourth Fire Shadow) of [Konohagakure](#). He was renowned and feared all over the world, across multiple nations as **Konoha's Yellow Flash** (木ノ葉の黄色い閃光, *Konoha no Kiiroi Senkō*, *English TV*: Yellow Flash of the Leaf).^[5] He died during the [Nine-Tailed Demon Fox's Attack](#), sacrificing his life to [seal](#) a half of the [Nine-Tails](#) into himself and the other half into his newborn son, [Naruto Uzumaki](#).

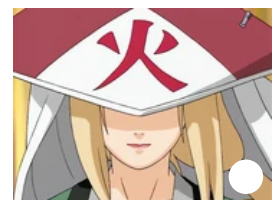


Minato Namikaze, the Fourth Hokage.

Fifth Hokage

Main article: [Tsunade](#)

Tsunade (綱手, *Tsunade*) is a descendant of the [Senju](#) and [Uzumaki Clan](#) and is one of [Konohagakure's Sannin](#). She is famed as the world's strongest [kunoichi](#) and its greatest [medical-nin](#). The repeated loss of her loved ones caused Tsunade to later abandon the life of a shinobi for many years. She is eventually persuaded to return to Konoha and take on the mantle of **Fifth Hokage** (五代目火影, *Godaime Hokage*, literally meaning: Fifth Fire Shadow), where her skills prove invaluable to the village.



Tsunade, the Fifth Hokage.

Sixth Hokage

Main article: [Kakashi Hatake](#)

Kakashi Hatake (はたけカカシ, *Hatake Kakashi*) is a [shinobi](#) of [Konohagakure's Hatake clan](#). Famed as **Kakashi of the Sharingan** (写輪眼のカカシ, *Sharingan no Kakashi*) and the **Copy Ninja** (コピー忍者, *Kopi Ninja*), he is one of Konoha's most talented ninja, regularly looked to for advice and leadership despite his personal dislike of responsibility. To his students on [Team 7](#), Kakashi emphasises the importance of teamwork; he himself received this lesson, along with the Sharingan, from his childhood friend, [Obito Uchiha](#). After the [Fourth Shinobi World War](#), Kakashi becomes Konoha's **Sixth Hokage** (六代目火影, *Rokudaime Hokage*, literally meaning: Sixth Fire Shadow).



Kakashi Hatake, the Sixth Hokage.



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Seventh Hokage

Main article: [Naruto Uzumaki](#)

Naruto Uzumaki (うずまきナルト, *Uzumaki Naruto*) is a [shinobi](#) of [Konohagakure](#)'s [Uzumaki clan](#) and a [reincarnation](#) and descendant of [Asura Ōtsutsuki](#). He became the [jinchūriki](#) of the [Nine-Tails](#) on the [day of his birth](#) – a fate that caused him to be shunned by most of Konoha throughout his childhood. After joining [Team Kakashi](#), Naruto worked hard to gain the village's acknowledgement all the while chasing his dream to become **Hokage**. In the following years, through many hardships and ordeals, he became a capable ninja, regarded as a hero both by the villagers, and soon after, the rest of the world, becoming known as the **Hero of the Hidden Leaf** (木ノ葉隠れの英雄, *Konohagakure no Eiyū*, *literally meaning: Hero of the Hidden Tree Leaves*). He soon proved to be one of the main factors in winning the [Fourth Shinobi World War](#), leading him to achieve his dream and become the village's **Seventh Hokage** (七代目火影, *Nanadaime Hokage*, *literally meaning: Seventh Fire Shadow*).



Naruto Uzumaki, the Seventh Hokage.

Candidates

Sixth Hokage Candidate

Main article: [Danzō Shimura](#)

Danzō Shimura (志村ダンゾウ, *Shimura Danzō*) was an elder of [Konohagakure](#). As the founder and leader of [Root](#), Danzō gained notoriety as **The Darkness of the Shinobi** (忍の闇, *Shinobi no Yami*, *English TV: The Shinobi of Darkness*)^[6] because of his frequent unsanctioned actions and his often-suspected (but rarely proven) undermining of specific Konoha personnel. Despite his decades of suspicious deeds, Danzō only ever acted in what he believed were the village's best interests. He was appointed the **Sixth Hokage Candidate** (六代目火影候補, *Rokudaime Hokage Kōho*, *literally meaning: Sixth Fire Shadow Candidate*)^[7] after [Pain's Assault](#), but died before he could be formally approved to the position.



Danzō Shimura, the Sixth Hokage Candidate.

Provisional Eighth Hokage

Main article: [Shikamaru Nara](#)

Shikamaru Nara (奈良シカマル, *Nara Shikamaru*) is a shinobi of [Konohagakure's Nara clan](#). Though lazy by nature, Shikamaru has a rare intellect that consistently allows him to prevail in combat. The responsibilities that these successes leave him with cause him frequent annoyance, but he gladly accepts them so that he may be of service to his fellow members of [Team Asuma](#), and to prove himself to generations of the past and future. As an adult, he served as chief aide to [Naruto](#) when he became the Seventh **Hokage**, and took the title of **Eighth Hokage** (八代目火影, *Hachidaime Hokage*, literally meaning: Eighth Fire Shadow)^[a] on a provisional basis^[a] when Naruto [disappeared](#) and was believed to have been killed.



Shikamaru Nara, the provisional Eighth Hokage.

Trivia

- Hashirama intended for his co-founder, [Madara Uchiha](#), to be the First Hokage, but the village's population instead selected Hashirama. Madara feared that Hashirama's selection was the first step in making the Hokage office an extension of the [Senju clan](#)'s authority.^[10] Ultimately, all of the village's Hokage have a connection to a previous Hokage, which traces origins to the Senju in some way.
 - The [Second](#) was the chief aide and younger brother of the First.
 - The [Third](#) was a student of both the First and Second.
 - The [Fourth](#) was a student of [one](#) of the Third's [students](#).
 - The [Fifth](#) is direct family to the First and Second, and was a student of the Third.
 - The [Sixth](#) was a student of the Fourth and (in the anime) an aide to the Third.
 - The [Seventh](#) is the son of the Fourth, the godchild of one of the Third's students, a student of the Sixth, and distantly related to the First, Second, and Fifth.
 - Ironically, according to [Naruto Mobile](#), the title of Hokage was named after Madara's ninjutsu, like how the village's name was based off of Hashirama's ninjutsu.^[11]
- During his life, the Third Hokage was said to be the strongest Hokage in the village's history as well as strongest [Kage](#) of his time.^{[12][13][14]} Years later, the Seventh Hokage was recognised in the same way.^[15]
- [Orochimaru](#) was a prime candidate to be the Fourth Hokage, but was passed over because he didn't embody the Will of Fire.^[16]
- [Fugaku Uchiha](#)'s talents were considered comparable to [Minato Namikaze](#) and the [Sannin](#), even viewed as a prime candidate to become Fourth Hokage. Despite this, his name was not even suggested. Many in the [Uchiha Clan](#) suspected this was due to the village officials not wanting the Uchiha Clan on centre stage.^[17]
- Jiraiya was considered for the Hokage position multiple times: first prior to the Third's retirement,^[18] again after the Fourth's death, and once again after the Third's death.^[19] He refused each time because he believed he couldn't give the office the attention it deserved.
- The first six Hokage had their official photographs taken while wearing a ceremonial necklace of sorts.^[20]
- At one point, [Sasuke](#) claimed [Itachi](#) to be the "true" Hokage on account of the latter's hefty sacrifices for the sake of the village. A [reincarnated](#) Hiruzen would later share this sentiment.
- According to [Boruto](#), Naruto refers to Sasuke as the "Shadow Hokage", due to

Naruto protecting the village from the inside whereas Sasuke supports Naruto and protects the village from the outside. However, Sasuke never recognises himself as a Hokage due to his past criminal acts and his personal life-long journey of atonement.^[20]

- In the [Genjutsu World](#) seen in *Road to Ninja: Naruto the Movie*, [Kizashi Haruno](#) was the Fourth Hokage. Like the real Fourth Hokage, he gave his life to save the village.
- [Naruto Uzumaki](#) was made Hokage for a week in the storyline of *Naruto: Ultimate Ninja 3*.
- Despite the Hokage being the grand leader of Konohagakure, the [Konoha Council](#) still has some authority over the Hokage, able to vote and have the current Hokage be removed from their position.
- In the anime, it is revealed that a Konoha-nin does not need any specific rank first to become Hokage, as Naruto remained a genin his entire career before becoming Seventh Hokage.^[21]
- [Might Guy](#) was made Hokage ("Guykage" as it was named) in the *Rock Lee's Springtime of Youth Full Power Ninja Chronicles* spin-off.
- In Jiraiya's novel *The Tale of the Utterly Gutsy Shinobi*, the village leader of Shuku is called the **Kokage** as an obvious homage to the Hokage position.
- Several victims of the [Infinite Tsukuyomi](#) dream of different Hokage:
 - [Kiba Inuzuka](#) dreams that he is Hokage, a position he uses to declare a national holiday for dogs.
 - [Tsunade](#) dreams that [Dan Katō](#) is Hokage.
 - In the anime, [Karin](#) dreams that [Sasuke Uchiha](#) is the Sixth Hokage.
- It's tradition that a Konoha shinobi's first [mission](#) is directly received from the Hokage.^[22]

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References

13. *Naruto* chapter 94, page 12
14. *Naruto* chapter 140, page 3
15. *Boruto* episode 12
16. *Naruto* chapter 121, pages 6-7
17. *Itachi Shinden: Book of Bright Light*
18. *Naruto* chapter 366, page 12
19. *Naruto* chapter 140, page 10
20. *Boruto: Naruto the Movie*
21. *Boruto* episode 48
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